Magic Monopoly: Game Design

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The Story

A curse has scrambled every fairy tale into one single story. Whoever owns the most of it when every rival goes broke gets to write The End.

At Sleeping Beauty's christening, the fairies gave the baby princess their blessings. One fairy wasn't invited, so she cursed the storybook instead. Its pages were torn out and bound back in the wrong order, and now every tale runs straight into the next.

Hansel's breadcrumbs lead onto Little Red Riding Hood's path, the Big Bad Wolf is loose in every story, and Peter Pan is flying right over the middle of it all. You are a would-be Author racing to claim the pages before the last one turns.

The Magic Mirror tells the story. The host's screen is the Mirror, and it narrates the game out loud as you play, with its lines written live by Meta's Muse Spark. Cards stay short; the Mirror supplies the drama. Its lines are in the Magic Mirror Script below.

The board is the book. Each lap is a read-through. GO is "Once Upon a Time," each color set is one tale, and the board climbs from Hansel and Gretel's Black Forest to Snow White's Mirror Hall.

Every game plays out in three acts, which the Mirror announces as they begin:

1. **Act 1, Cursed:** everyone starts with nothing, like Hansel and Gretel lost in the woods.
2. **Act 2, Stories Collide:** begins when the first player completes a tale, and the Mirror names who rules it.
3. **Act 3, The Final Chapter:** begins with the first Castle or the first bankruptcy, and runs until one Author is left.

The win condition is classic Monopoly: the last player who isn't bankrupt wins.

Tokens, Currency and Buildings

There are three tokens, so a game seats up to 3 players. Classic Monopoly allows up to 8, so more tokens can be added later.

Token	Who they are in the story
Wizard's Hat	An apprentice whose hat does all the actual magic
Castle	A tiny kingdom with very big plans
Crown	A royal heir, 47th in line and working on it

Currency: Gold (G). Every player starts with 1,500 Gold and collects 200 Gold for passing Once Upon a Time. If you show bills, use the classic denominations: 1, 5, 10, 20, 50, 100 and 500.

Buildings: Cottages upgrade to Castles.

- **Cottages** replace houses. A property can hold up to 4, and the bank has 32.
- **Castles** replace hotels. A Castle replaces 4 Cottages, and the bank has 12.
- Build evenly across a tale, exactly as in classic Monopoly.

The Castle token shares a name with the building, so the Mirror says "the Castle token" when it means the player piece.

The Board

Each color set is one famous fairy tale, matched to the color it's known for. Every space is a real place you could stand in, sit in or own, and the spaces follow their tale in story order. Prices climb from rags to royalty: the Black Forest is the cheapest property, and Mirror Hall, where the narrator lives, is the priciest.

Color	Tale	Why this color	Spaces, in story order
Brown	Hansel and Gretel	Gingerbread and the dark woods	Black Forest → Gingerbread House
Light blue	Cinderella	Her blue ball gown	Stepmother's Manor → Pumpkin Carriage → Royal Ballroom
Pink	Sleeping Beauty	The roses that grow over her palace	Maleficent's Lair → Spindle Tower → Rosewood Palace
Orange	The Three Little Pigs	Straw, sticks and brick	Straw Hut → Stick Cabin → Brick House

Color	Tale	Why this color	Spaces, in story order
Red	Little Red Riding Hood	Her red hood	Riding Hood Lane → Wildflower Meadow → Grandmother's House
Yellow	Beauty and the Beast	Belle's golden ball gown	Belle's Village → Beast's Library → West Wing
Green	Peter Pan	Peter's green tunic and Tinker Bell's glow	Pixie Hollow → Mermaid Lagoon → Jolly Roger
Dark blue	Snow White	Her dark blue dress and the Queen's midnight magic	Seven Dwarfs' Mine → Mirror Hall

The pigs' homes get pricier as they get sturdier, Tinker Bell's Pixie Hollow opens the green set, and the narrator's own home sits at the top of the board. Aladdin appears through Magic Carpet Weavers, Magic Lamp and the Genie cards rather than a color set.

The railroads are four Enchanted Workshops. Each one makes a famous magical item and runs a gift shop out front. Landing on one means you stop to shop, so you pay the owner. The more workshops one player owns, the more famous their brand gets, so prices climb: 25 / 50 / 100 / 200 Gold.

- **Geppetto's Toy Workshop:** wooden puppets and toys (Pinocchio).
- **Glass Slipper Glassworks:** one perfect slipper at a time (Cinderella).
- **Magic Carpet Weavers:** hand-woven flying carpets (Aladdin).
- **Poisoned Apple Orchard:** the shiniest apples in the kingdom (Snow White).

The utilities both grant wishes: Magic Lamp is the Electric Company, and Wishing Well Water Works is the Water Works. Their rent is a roll of the dice, like any wish.

#	Space	Kind	Tale (color)	Price (G)	Classic space
0	Once Upon a Time	Corner			GO
1	Black Forest	Property	Hansel and Gretel (brown)	60	Mediterranean Ave
2	Chest of Spells	Card			Community Chest
3	Gingerbread House	Property	Hansel and Gretel (brown)	60	Baltic Ave

#	Space	Kind	Tale (color)	Price (G)	Classic space
4	Rumpelstiltskin's Bargain	Tax (pay 200)	Rumpelstiltskin		Income Tax
5	Geppetto's Toy Workshop	Workshop	Pinocchio	200	Reading Railroad
6	Stepmother's Manor	Property	Cinderella (light blue)	100	Oriental Ave
7	Crystal Ball	Card			Chance
8	Pumpkin Carriage	Property	Cinderella (light blue)	100	Vermont Ave
9	Royal Ballroom	Property	Cinderella (light blue)	120	Connecticut Ave
10	Rapunzel's Tower	Corner	Rapunzel		Jail / Just Visiting
11	Maleficent's Lair	Property	Sleeping Beauty (pink)	140	St. Charles Place
12	Magic Lamp	Utility	Aladdin	150	Electric Company
13	Spindle Tower	Property	Sleeping Beauty (pink)	140	States Ave
14	Rosewood Palace	Property	Sleeping Beauty (pink)	160	Virginia Ave
15	Glass Slipper Glassworks	Workshop	Cinderella	200	Pennsylvania Railroad
16	Straw Hut	Property	The Three Little Pigs (orange)	180	St. James Place
17	Chest of Spells	Card			Community Chest
18	Stick Cabin	Property	The Three Little Pigs (orange)	180	Tennessee Ave
19	Brick House	Property	The Three Little Pigs (orange)	200	New York Ave
20	The Hundred-Year Nap	Corner	Sleeping Beauty		Free Parking
21	Riding Hood Lane	Property	Little Red Riding Hood (red)	220	Kentucky Ave
22	Crystal Ball	Card			Chance
23	Wildflower Meadow	Property	Little Red Riding Hood (red)	220	Indiana Ave
24	Grandmother's House	Property	Little Red Riding Hood (red)	240	Illinois Ave
25	Magic Carpet Weavers	Workshop	Aladdin	200	B&O Railroad
26	Belle's Village	Property	Beauty and the Beast (yellow)	260	Atlantic Ave

#	Space	Kind	Tale (color)	Price (G)	Classic space
27	Beast's Library	Property	Beauty and the Beast (yellow)	260	Ventnor Ave
28	Wishing Well Water Works	Utility	The Frog Prince	150	Water Works
29	West Wing	Property	Beauty and the Beast (yellow)	280	Marvin Gardens
30	Caught in the Witch's Garden	Corner	Rapunzel		Go to Jail
31	Pixie Hollow	Property	Peter Pan (green)	300	Pacific Ave
32	Mermaid Lagoon	Property	Peter Pan (green)	300	North Carolina Ave
33	Chest of Spells	Card			Community Chest
34	Jolly Roger	Property	Peter Pan (green)	320	Pennsylvania Ave
35	Poisoned Apple Orchard	Workshop	Snow White	200	Short Line
36	Crystal Ball	Card			Chance
37	Seven Dwarfs' Mine	Property	Snow White (dark blue)	350	Park Place
38	Huff and Puff	Tax (per building)	The Three Little Pigs		Luxury Tax
39	Mirror Hall	Property	Snow White (dark blue)	400	Boardwalk

The taxes belong to the two greediest characters in fairy tales. Rumpelstiltskin always wants something in return, and the Big Bad Wolf huffs and puffs at every house you've built, so Huff and Puff charges per building.

Rent and Building Costs

Every rent, building cost and mortgage value is the classic US one, in Gold (source). Owning a full tale with no Cottages doubles the base rent.

Property	Price (G)	Cottage cost (G)	Base rent	1 Cottage	2 Cottages	3 Cottages	4 Cottages	Castle	Mortgage (G)
Black Forest	60	50	2	10	30	90	160	250	30
Gingerbread House	60	50	4	20	60	180	320	450	30

Property	Price (G)	Cottage cost (G)	Base rent	1 Cottage	2 Cottages	3 Cottages	4 Cottages	Castle	Mortgage (G)
Stepmother's Manor	100	50	6	30	90	270	400	550	50
Pumpkin Carriage	100	50	6	30	90	270	400	550	50
Royal Ballroom	120	50	8	40	100	300	450	600	60
Maleficent's Lair	140	100	10	50	150	450	625	750	70
Spindle Tower	140	100	10	50	150	450	625	750	70
Rosewood Palace	160	100	12	60	180	500	700	900	80
Straw Hut	180	100	14	70	200	550	750	950	90
Stick Cabin	180	100	14	70	200	550	750	950	90
Brick House	200	100	16	80	220	600	800	1,000	100
Riding Hood Lane	220	150	18	90	250	700	875	1,050	110
Wildflower Meadow	220	150	18	90	250	700	875	1,050	110
Grandmother's House	240	150	20	100	300	750	925	1,100	120
Belle's Village	260	150	22	110	330	800	975	1,150	130
Beast's Library	260	150	22	110	330	800	975	1,150	130
West Wing	280	150	24	120	360	850	1,025	1,200	140
Pixie Hollow	300	200	26	130	390	900	1,100	1,275	150
Mermaid Lagoon	300	200	26	130	390	900	1,100	1,275	150
Jolly Roger	320	200	28	150	450	1,000	1,200	1,400	160
Seven Dwarfs' Mine	350	200	35	175	500	1,100	1,300	1,500	175
Mirror Hall	400	200	50	200	600	1,400	1,700	2,000	200

A Castle costs the same as one Cottage, paid on top of the 4 Cottages it replaces.

- **Workshops** (Geppetto's Toy Workshop, Glass Slipper Glassworks, Magic Carpet Weavers, Poisoned Apple Orchard): 200 Gold each, mortgage 100. Rent is 25 / 50 / 100 / 200 Gold for owning 1 / 2 / 3 / 4.

- **Utilities** (Magic Lamp, Wishing Well Water Works): 150 Gold each, mortgage 75. Rent is 4× the dice roll if you own one, 10× if you own both.
- **Unmortgaging** costs the mortgage value plus 10%.

Crystal Ball (replaces Chance)

The Crystal Ball shows your fate, and fate can be good or bad. There are 16 cards with the same effects as the classic Chance cards, each starring a famous character. The card shows only its title and effect; the Mirror speaks the line. Movement cards pay 200 Gold for passing Once Upon a Time unless they send you to the Tower.

#	Card (shown)	Effect	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
1	Mirror, Mirror	Advance to Mirror Hall (39)	"The Queen wants to know who's fairest. You're about to find out."
2	Back to Page One	Advance to Once Upon a Time, collect 200	"The book flips back to the beginning. Once upon a time..."
3	What Big Eyes	Advance to Grandmother's House (24)	"Grandmother has been expecting you. She looks... different."
4	Summoned by Maleficent	Advance to Maleficent's Lair (11)	"Maleficent never got an invitation, so she sent you one."
5	Shopping Spree	Nearest Workshop; if owned, pay 2× rent	"A sale sign catches your eye. It's not a sale. Pay double."
6	Gift Shop Rush	Nearest Workshop; if owned, pay 2× rent	"Everyone in the book wants a souvenir today. Prices doubled."
7	The Genie's Fine Print	Nearest Utility; if owned, roll and pay 10×	"You rubbed the lamp. The genie charges by the wish."
8	Golden Egg	Collect 50	"Jack's goose laid an extra golden egg in your hat."
9	**Flynn Rider to the Rescue**	Escape Rapunzel's Tower free (keep until used)	"A charming thief climbs the tower, flashes a smile, and gets you out."

#	Card (shown)	Effect	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
10	Spoilers!	Move back 3 spaces	"You read the last page early. Step back and pretend you didn't."
11	Caught by the Witch	Go directly to Rapunzel's Tower	"The witch caught you nibbling her house. Up the tower you go."
12	Fee-Fi-Fo-Fum	Pay 25 per Cottage, 100 per Castle	"A giant stomped through your buildings. The repairs are on you."
13	Pinocchio's Nose	Pay 15	"You told a fib. Your nose grew, and so did your fine."
14	New Toy Day	Advance to Geppetto's Toy Workshop (5)	"Geppetto has a new puppet in the window. You have to see it."
15	Belle of the Ball	Pay each player 50	"You're the star of the royal ball, so you pay for everyone's carriage home."
16	The Golden Harp	Collect 150	"You sold the giant's golden harp. It wouldn't stop singing anyway."

Chest of Spells (replaces Community Chest)

There are 16 Chest of Spells cards with the same effects as the classic Community Chest cards. Each card is a spell: some are blessings and some are curses, cast by characters from Disney, Pixar and the classic fairy tales.

#	Spell (shown)	Effect	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
1	Genie's Snap	Advance to Once Upon a Time, collect 200	"The Genie snaps his fingers and sends you straight back to page one."

#	Spell (shown)	Effect	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
2	Straw Into Gold	Collect 200	"Rumpelstiltskin spun your straw into gold. You'll owe him later."
3	Frog Curse	Pay 50	"A witch turned you into a frog for the afternoon. Changing back costs extra."
4	Pixie Dust	Collect 50	"Tinker Bell sprinkles pixie dust on your coin purse."
5	**Fairy Godmother's Favor**	Escape Rapunzel's Tower free (keep until used)	"A wave of the wand turns a pumpkin into your getaway coach."
6	Maleficent's Curse	Go directly to Rapunzel's Tower	"Maleficent curses you to the tower. She does love a dramatic entrance."
7	Genie's Wish	Collect 100	"The Genie grants you one wish. You wish for 100 Gold. Modest."
8	Sea Witch Refund	Collect 20	"Ursula refunds part of your contract. She hates doing it."
9	Un-Birthday Party	Collect 10 from each player	"The Mad Hatter declares it your un-birthday. Everyone owes you a present."
10	Merlin's Lucky Charm	Collect 100	"Merlin's spell doubles your pocket change, then doubles it again."
11	Poisoned Apple	Pay 100	"The Evil Queen's apple. The healer charges extra."
12	Ursula's Contract	Pay 50	"You signed the sea witch's contract without reading it."
13	Lumiere's Tip	Collect 25	"Lumiere lights up a dinner for a royal guest, and you get the tip."
14	Elsa's Blizzard	Pay 40 per Cottage, 115 per Castle	"Elsa lost control again. Every building you own is frozen solid."

#	Spell (shown)	Effect	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
15	Mirror's Compliment	Collect 10	"You are the second fairest of them all. I said what I said."
16	Ariel's Treasure	Collect 100	"Ariel trades you a fork from her treasure collection. It's worth more than you'd think."

Corners and Special Spaces

Every special space keeps its classic rule except Huff and Puff, which charges per building instead of a flat 100 Gold.

Space	Rule	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
Once Upon a Time (0)	Collect 200 Gold when you land on or pass it	"A new chapter begins. 200 Gold for you."
Rapunzel's Tower (10)	Jail. Landing here by roll means Just Visiting	Visiting: "You call up to a window with no door. Nobody lets down any hair."
The Hundred-Year Nap (20)	Nothing happens	"You prick your finger on a spindle and doze off. Nothing happens. Probably."
Caught in the Witch's Garden (30)	Go directly to Rapunzel's Tower and don't collect 200	"You were caught picking from the witch's garden. Up the tower you go."
Rumpelstiltskin's Bargain (4)	Pay 200 Gold	"Rumpelstiltskin will take 200 Gold, or your firstborn. Your choice."
Huff and Puff (38)	Pay 25 per Cottage and 100 per Castle	"The Big Bad Wolf huffs, and puffs, and charges you for every house you own."

Getting out of the Tower follows the classic rule. Pay 50 Gold before rolling, use an escape card (Flynn Rider to the Rescue or Fairy Godmother's Favor), or roll doubles. After three failed doubles attempts, pay 50 Gold and move.

Rolling doubles three times in a row gets you caught in the witch's garden and sent to the Tower.

All other rules are unchanged: auctions when a player declines to buy, even building, mortgages and bankruptcy.

Magic Mirror Script

The Mirror speaks one short line per game event, from the host's screen so the whole room hears it once. Card and corner lines live in their tables above; these cover everything else. `{player}`, `{space}`, `{owner}`, `{amount}` and `{tale}` are filled in by the game.

The 10 story variants, mid-game story switches and a spoken line for every move are on Magic Mirror Stories.

Game events:

Event	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
Game starts	"Mirror, mirror, on the screen. A curse has bound every fairy tale into one book, and its last page is blank. Let's find out who writes it."
Act 2 begins (first tale completed)	"The stories are colliding. {player} now rules all of {tale}."
Act 3 begins (first Castle or first bankruptcy)	"We've reached the final chapter. Not everyone gets a happy ending."
Land on an unowned property	"{space} has no owner. Will {player} claim it?"
Buy a property	"{space} now belongs to {player}."
Nobody buys, auction starts	"No takers? Then let the bidding begin."
Pay rent	"{player} pays {owner} {amount} Gold. Fairy tales aren't free."
Complete a tale	"{player} owns every page of {tale}. Rents just doubled."
Build a Cottage	"A cottage rises at {space}."
Build a Castle	"A castle! {space} will never be the same."

Event	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
Mortgage a property	"{player} mortgages {space}. A little man will want it back, with interest."
Land on a Workshop	"Welcome to the gift shop. Everything's magic, and nothing's cheap."
Land on a Utility	"Roll the dice. The magic meter is running."
Look into the Crystal Ball	"The crystal ball is clouding over..." (then the card's line)
Draw from the Chest of Spells	"The chest creaks open, and a spell flies out..." (then the card's line)
Escape the Tower with doubles	"Doubles! You climb down your own hair."
Pay to leave the Tower	"Fifty Gold buys a very long ladder."
Three doubles in a row	"Too lucky. Suspiciously lucky. The witch saw you."
A player goes bankrupt	"{player}'s story ends here. The book closes on them."
Game ends	"And {player} wrote the final words: The End."

Tale entrances: spoken the first time anyone lands in each tale.

Tale	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
Hansel and Gretel	"The Black Forest. If a house looks edible, it's a trap."
Cinderella	"A stepmother, a pumpkin and a ball at midnight. Be home on time."
Sleeping Beauty	"Maleficent's Lair, where a sleeping curse is waiting. Mind the spindles."
The Three Little Pigs	"Three little houses, one big wolf. Build wisely."
Little Red Riding Hood	"Little Red's woods. Stay on the path."

Tale	Magic Mirror line (spoken)
Beauty and the Beast	"A quiet village, a grumpy beast, and a rose that's running out of petals."
Peter Pan	"Second star to the right, and straight on to Neverland. Tinker Bell is waiting."
Snow White	"Welcome to my hall. Yes, I'm the mirror. Yes, I'm judging you."

Build Notes

The engine is classic Monopoly with themed text, so the board, both decks and the Mirror script can all go straight into config data.

Deck logic:

- Keep two queues of 16 cards each, `crystalBall` and `spellChest`, and shuffle each one once at game start.
- To draw, take the card from the front, resolve it, then push it onto the back. Because the deck cycles, it never needs a reshuffle.
- An escape card (Flynn Rider to the Rescue or Fairy Godmother's Favor) leaves the queue and goes into the player's hand. It returns to the back of its deck when used.
- Save each deck's current order with the game state, so a resumed game draws the same next card.

Card effect types: these 9 types cover all 32 cards.

- `moveTo` (position, collect 200 Gold when passing Once Upon a Time)
- `moveBy` (−3)
- `nearest` (workshop at 2× rent, or utility at 10× dice)
- `money` (+ or −)
- `payEachPlayer`
- `collectFromEachPlayer`
- `repairs` (per Cottage, per Castle; Huff and Puff uses it too)
- `goToTower`
- `escapeCard`

Example card record:

```
{
  "id": "cb-03",
  "deck": "crystalBall",
  "title": "What Big Eyes",
  "effect": { "type": "moveTo", "position": 24, "collectGo": true },
  "mirrorLine": "Grandmother has been expecting you. She looks... different."
}
```

Magic Mirror voice:

- Play audio only from the host's screen; players' phones stay silent, like a Kahoot host display.
- Queue lines so they never overlap. If the queue backs up, drop routine lines such as rent before story lines.
- Keep every line under about 5 seconds so turns don't drag.
- Pre-generate audio for the fixed lines (cards, corners, tale entrances) before the demo, so venue Wi-Fi can't break the narration. Only templated lines with player names need live generation.
- Show each line as an on-screen caption. The demo floor will be loud, and it doubles as accessibility.
- Add a mute button for the host.